ICAO Doc 9303 Part 4: Specifications for Machine Readable Passports (TD3 Size)

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1. Physical Dimensions and Book Structure

A TD3 size passport booklet comprises a data page with dimensions of 125.0 mm x 88.0 mm (nominal, ISO/IEC 7810 ID-3). The biographical data page is embedded as either a flexible laminated paper sheet or an integrated rigid polycarbonate leaf fused directly into the spine binding with tamper-evident stitching.

2. MRZ Structure for Passports (TD3 2x44)

The TD3 MRZ contains two lines of 44 characters each (total 88 characters). Line 1 format: positions 1-2 document code ('P<'), positions 3-5 issuing state, positions 6-44 holder's name (surname<<given_names). Line 2 format: positions 1-9 passport number, pos 10 check digit, positions 11-13 nationality code, positions 14-19 birth date (YYMMDD), pos 20 check digit, pos 21 sex, positions 22-27 expiry date (YYMMDD), pos 28 check digit, positions 29-42 personal/optional number, pos 43 check digit, pos 44 composite check digit.

3. Security Thread and Optically Variable Devices

The biographical data page must incorporate at least three level-1 security features visible to the naked eye: an optically variable ink (OVI) displaying distinct colour-shift under varying angles of illumination, a holographic DOVID patch overlapping the edge of the facial portrait, and tactile laser-engraved micro-relief.